



UNITED STATES
Microsoft is cooperating with the Chinese government to censor the company's newly-launched Chinese-language Web portal, a spokesman said. The policy affects blogs created through the MSN Spaces service, said Adam Sohn, a global sales and marketing director at MSN.

UNITED STATES
eBay is no longer the domain of the tech-savvy or even those with a computer. Now, all you need is a way to get to Melanie Meyers' QuikDrop eBay store in Dallas, which proudly proclaims under its title: "We sell your stuff on eBay."

GERMANY
For good Catholics, the search for a spouse is like looking for a needle in a modern haystack of divorce, adultery, and permissive social values. In Germany, help is on the way in the form of an online dating portal, www.kathTreff.org. Members thinking about marriage fill in details such as typical alcohol consumption and even favourite saint!

MALAYSIA
In Malaysia, broadband is practically a pre-requisite for tech-savvy tourists. Renovation and re-branding to include trendy features and facilities such as broadband facilities, new dining concepts, and spa facilities are amongst the measures local hotels are looking at to enhance their competitive edge.

SOUTH AFRICA
The country is about to embark on its biggest hi-tech training and job creation push yet, with the unveiling of the McKinsey report into call centres. It predicts that South Africa can create 1,50,000 jobs in the next three years if it does what's necessary to lure outsourcers.

AUSTRALIA
IT is not hot in Universities any more. Queensland's Bond University has axed its IT faculty in a move reflecting a massive downturn in demand for computing courses at universities around Australia. Applications for IT courses have fallen by almost 50 per cent in some states.

The supercomputer will be more powerful and efficient than a conventional system of similar physical size. If it can be made easy enough to program, the researchers behind the machine say it could usher in a new generation of compact and energy-saving supercomputers over the coming decade.

Conventional microprocessors consume thousands of watts of power

and require specialised cooling. Once configured, a FPGA chip is faster, smaller and less power-hungry.

The researchers at the Centre are building a computer that will incorporate 64 FPGA processing units and would be capable of operating at 1 teraflop—one trillion mathematical operations per second, a fairly modest speed by modern supercomputing standards, as the fastest machines can operate at hundreds of teraflops.

However, the Edinburgh system will be up to 100 times more energy-efficient than a conventional supercomputer of equivalent computing power. The 64-node FPGA machine will also need only as much space as four conventional PCs, while a normal 1-teraflop supercomputer would fill a room.

Illustrations Harsho Mohan Chatteraj



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Nerdworld.com

This is a Web site about nerd culture for the burgeoning nerd community. Nerdworld.com celebrates nerd lifestyle and popular culture, including nerd work, fashion, dating, cooking, sports and entertainment. The site also features nerd chat rooms and assemblies, nerd IQ tests, calendar services, and even a nerd store!

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